



Write to the Editor

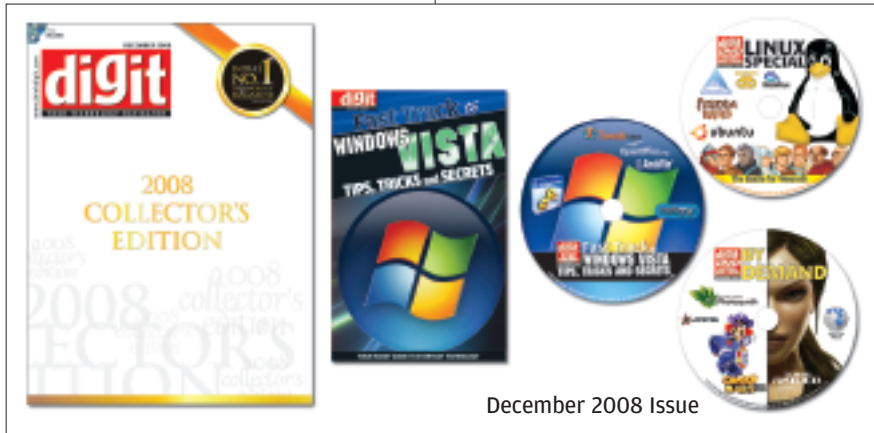
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Digit will publish the best letters on these pages. Letters may be edited for clarity. Please include your complete address in all communication.

For subscription queries send an e-mail to help@thinkdigit.com

Inbox



December 2008 Issue

20 questions?

First of all, I must congratulate you on your “2008 Collector’s Edition”. I am a regular subscriber to *Digit* and this is the first time that I have been completely satisfied by an issue.

Initially, I was not all too pleased when our desi magazine was taken over by videsi 9.9, but then you have done wonderfully. Earlier, the magazine used to reach me after a fortnight; now it arrives within 10 days.

Earlier, I used to fear that the package would be pilfered and I would lose some CDs; now the packaging is tamper-proof. The *Fast Track* has better paper quality, has colour pictures and now even features tutorials; a demand I have making since long. The magazine features articles that can be read even by non-geeks (like myself), which are informative and thankfully short. Who on Earth would want to read a “textbook” anyway? Referring to your editorial column on the cover; I don’t think *Digit* is a film magazine that anyone would buy on the basis of cover. No matter what you put on cover, we will buy anyway. I liked the idea of simplicity, but frankly I miss the gorgeous babes on the cover :)

What matters most to the reader is the stuff inside. The CDs now feature softwares for Linux as well. What more can I ask from *Digit*? But, these compliments shouldn’t make you complacent, you must outdo yourself through constant innovation.

Now, coming to some shortcomings. Sometimes, the software in your CD/DVD labeled as Freeware turns out to be actually Shareware or Trialware. I usually don’t install software that I

have to uninstall later.

Page 68 on Laptops: “Price of notebooks range from Rs. 20,000 to Rs. 26,000” What? Must have been a typo. There have been many such errors; I guess they have been missed in a hurry to get the magazine ready. I wonder why Evolution for windows was left out in your e-mail clients article. When Chrome beta was featured in comparison of browsers in your revious issue, why was Evolution (beta) not included? Most important exclusion: why was handycam / camcorders excluded in the Zero1 awards? Why is “Beat That!” feature missing in recent editions? Lastly, why is your Agent 001 so muscular?

Sridhar Rao
Devangere

On page 68 of Digit December 2008, the text reads, “prices of **netbooks** range...” You have mistakenly read this as *notebooks*.

Although we did make an exception for Chrome, we’re not likely to include beta versions too often in software comparisons.

Agent 001 has an acute body image problem, and spends unhealthy amounts of time in the gym. That said, he is currently seeking therapy... fingers-crossed!

Team Digit

Feedback galore

I bought my first copy of *Digit* in April 2004 and have been buying it since then. Initially, I bought it only for game demos and software — it took me a few months to realise that I was missing the fun — the real cream is in the articles inside the magazine.

I am fascinated by computer technology and games right from the

day I started reading *Digit*. It has been invaluable to my career and personal interests. When my dad bought me a Computer in 2003 I didn’t even know where the CPU was inside the cabinet! Now I have assembled nearly ten desktops for my friends just by reading your mag! I even get queries about games and software installations from my friends. I refer to *Digit* heavily for these purposes and more importantly, I love it!

Now for some feedback:

1. I really really enjoy your regulars especially, Agent 001, Tech Quiz, People Who Changed Computing and Inbox.

2. The Visual Buying guide blew me away; it rocks, it’s superb, I strongly request you to continue the ‘Visual Buying Guide’ hereafter.

3. The thing I like about *Digit* very much is its Indian-feel and approach to the computer and tech world. Keep it up guys, your real style is inside the articles.

4. Regarding Fast Track, it rocks. Though I have some suggestions for that.

5. How about starting a new regular section on the mag called “Digit Projects”, which includes both hardware and software projects that enthusiastic students and professionals can emulate?

6. I read on an Intel website that game engines can be used for many purposes other than entertainment. For example Epic’s Unreal Engine 3 is currently used for medical simulations and architectural fly-throughs. Which made me wonder if physics engines like ‘Havoc’ used in games like *Half-life 2* can be used in schools to teach complex physics to students! Since the *Doom 3* engine will also be open-sourced in the future, is it possible to do such things?

7. I feel sad for those Indians who see gaming as an amateurish or childish activity.

Krishna Prasath

We’re glad we could help you follow-up on your passion for technology.

We also thank you for taking the time to give us detailed feedback, which is our favourite kind. We will try and cover points 5 and 6 in upcoming issues, and yes we agree with you on point number 7, because all of us are also avid gamers, and appreciate the entertainment and skill enhancement it brings.

Team Digit

The best buy

The year end issue of *Digit* is indeed useful for many reasons to cite. Though the cover page is prosaic and unimpressive your justification for the same is one step ahead in reasonable maneuvers. Please take that as a compliment. However, I have become a fan of yours of late, for the language you use and the way you make yourself clear.

The second aspect of *Digit*’s December issue is that, I found many of the articles very informative. I was in a state of confusion in selecting a laptop and a inkjet printer for my son and your ‘Best Buy’ tags helped me to easily get the best of the class. I had missed many issues of *Digit* on several occasions, and this issue compensated the loss.

I am quite impressed by the following articles:

- *The very best products of 2008*
- *Taming the Internet.*
- *Improve windows font display*
- *Keep it simple*

The Editor also made a passing reference to my earlier letter about jargon in the editorial “*Never judge a book...*”. I feel honoured and enthused to make correspondence with the Numero Uno.

Sreenath Rayasam

We’re glad our December issue was that useful to you, and happened to cover exactly what you were looking for. Like we’ve told our readers all along, we really do read all your letters. In fact, the editor has promised to make it a point to respond to all from now on.

Team Digit

Errata

I just wanted to point out that there is an error in the crossword puzzle on page no. 164: the clue given in 15 down suggests the answer is STEP UP but since the transformer reduces output voltage it should be a STEP DOWN transformer, if I am not mistaken.

I’d also like to thank you about the C++ Fast Track. I’m learning C++ and the book was of great help.

Kayomars Batliwalla

You are absolutely right. We got it wrong in the crossword. Since no one came close to answering the crossword correctly, and you spotted the mistakes we made, we feel that you deserve the prize for the crossword.

Team Digit

On the Digit archive

Congratulations and thank you for a great magazine which is now is a part of my life! I am a Web Designer and a subscriber to *Digit* for the past two years. Each and every *Digit* issue is like a gift for me. I have arranged all the CDs and DVDs month-wise so that I can find them when I need to. The Digit Archive helped me a lot to manage this.

I noticed that you have stopped providing the Digit Archive software in the CD for the past few months. What happened? Are you in the process of debugging? Please make that available as soon as you can.

I also have a few suggestions. Please write Fast Tracks to AJAX, PHP, XHTML and Dynamic Flash XML. It will help Web Designers like me.

Debraj

The Digit Archive is undergoing a change at the moment. We hope to launch version 2.0 soon, with added features. As to your suggestion for Fast Tracks — we hope you enjoy the one on PHP this issue which comes with a video guide on the DVD.

Team Digit

Expert advice

I’m an avid reader of Digit and December’s issue was the best of all. However, some part of the magazine really let me down. A couple of questions answered by the experts in “Q&A” were totally wrong.

One of the questions with title “Is the file boot.com corrupted?” gave me a feeling that the person (Jagdeep Virdhi Q&A expert) is totally unaware of what it really is. It’s actually a trojan which creates some files in registry and runs along with Explorer. The only way to remove this trojan is to use “Smart Virus Remover” software. You also need to click “Restore Windows Default Settings”. The same applies to the question titled “USB Flash drivers and viruses”. By using that software you can also fix folder options problems, registry problems etc.

R. Vivek

The solution given points readers to remove all Autorun.inf files, which is what this virus uses to load into the system. The answer was incomplete, though, and the virus removal instructions omitted.

Team Digit

Pirates no more

I have got an amazing mag in my hands which is called *Digit*. December issue was absolutely mind boggling. The most useful stuff was the soft copies of your magazine’s previous issues. I have already started browsing their Tips and Tricks section. Why don’t you include mobile applications which you used to?

And also you guys give more importance to Windows Mobile users by giving a list of applications for them and including it in the Tips and Tricks section, while most people in India have Nokia phones which run on Symbian. You know I have Nokia N95 8 GB lying unused because of lack of applications, and I don’t have an internet connection at home, so I can’t get compatible apps for it. That aside, your Mag simply rocks! Your cover page reflected simplicity and honesty, but inside it was extraordinary. Robert was right when he said “its not what’s on covers that matter, but what’s between them...”.

I think you should have been given best performer award to the iPhone in the mobile phones category, and not the N95 8GB, even if it’s my phone.

I also want to tell you that *Digit* has changed my life completely. I was a bigger pirate than those in *Pirates Of The Carribean* before reading your magazine, but now I use either licensed software or only Open Source ones.

This is all thanks to you guys, and that is why you are on top. It can be said that you are the iPod Touch of the PMP world. Thanks once again!

Kshitij Rawat

The point that symbian applications and symbian relevent information will be more useful to readers in India is taken. We are relieving a lot of requests for providing phone based software on our DVDs and we are seriously considering it.

What really made us happy was that you stopped software piracy and moved on to open source software. This is really the way to go, and glad to know that we were a small part of this turn around.

Team Digit

